**Reformation Test Vocabulary and Key Terms**

003QSGV | Grade 10 History | Test Thursday, November 12, 2026

Explain each term's meaning and historical importance. Use this list with the 003QSG study guide.

**1 Luther and justification**

Study guide Questions 1–8 | P&C pp. 75–77 | 003B | 003H07

**Protestant Reformation** — The sixteenth-century movement that challenged Catholic teaching and authority and produced separate Protestant churches.

**Martin Luther** — German monk and professor whose criticism of indulgences developed into a break with Rome.

**Simony** — Buying or selling Church offices.

**Nepotism** — Favoring relatives when making appointments to Church offices.

**Johann Tetzel** — The indulgence preacher whose fundraising campaign helped provoke Luther's protest.

**Indulgence** — Catholic remission of temporal punishment after a sin's guilt has been forgiven. Fundraising campaigns blurred this distinction.

**Temporal punishment** — Punishment or purification that remains after a sin's guilt has been forgiven.

**Purgatory** — In Catholic teaching, a state of purification for those ultimately destined for heaven.

**Ninety-five Theses** — Luther's 1517 challenge to the indulgence campaign; the beginning of his public dispute with Church authorities.

**Excommunication** — Formal exclusion from Church communion. The pope excommunicated Luther in 1521.

**Diet of Worms and imperial ban** — At the 1521 imperial assembly, Luther refused to recant. Princes protected him from the subsequent imperial ban.

**Justification** — Being accepted as righteous before God. Luther and Trent disagreed over the relationship of faith and works.

**Sola fide** — Justification by faith alone. Luther taught that good works result from grace rather than earn it.

**Grace and good works** — Grace is God's freely given favor. In Luther's teaching, good deeds are consequences and evidence of grace, rather than its cause.

**Sola scriptura** — Scripture is the final authority for Christian doctrine. Luther argued that popes and councils could err and should be judged by Scripture.

**Priesthood of all believers** — Luther's claim that baptized Christians belong to one spiritual estate, although their offices differ. Laypeople and rulers therefore have a part in reform.

**Luther's Three Walls** — The claims that spiritual authority stands above temporal authority, only the pope may interpret Scripture, and only the pope may call a council. Luther challenged all three as barriers to reform.

**Reformation Test Vocabulary and Key Terms**
**2 Scripture rulers and the peasants**

Study guide Questions 9–13 | P&C pp. 78–80 | 003D Sections A B and D

**Peasants' Revolt and Twelve Articles** — In 1525, peasants appealed to Scripture to demand reforms, including choosing their pastors and release from serfdom. Their Third Article made obedience conditional on God's law.

**Serfdom** — A condition of unfreedom in which peasants owed obligations to lords. The peasants demanded release unless the Gospel could justify keeping them as serfs.

**Against the Murdering and Robbing Bands of the Peasants** — Luther's 1525 attack on the revolt. He appealed to Scripture to defend obedience to rulers and condemned the peasants' rebellion.

**Temporal or secular authority** — Political authority exercised by rulers and governments, distinguished from the authority of Church officials.

**Territorial rulers and imperial states** — The princes and other political estates within the Holy Roman Empire whose religious authority the Peace of Augsburg recognized.

**Peace of Augsburg** — The 1555 settlement allowing imperial states to choose Catholicism or Lutheranism as their public religion. Calvinists and Anabaptists were excluded.

**Right to emigrate** — Augsburg permitted subjects who changed religion to leave and sell property, subject to obligations and fees. It did not generally allow them to stay and worship freely.

**Ecclesiastical reservation** — A Catholic bishop or other church ruler who converted had to leave his office and its property. He could not take the church territory into Lutheranism.

**3 Calvin**

Study guide Questions 14–18 | P&C pp. 80–83 | 003H05

**John Calvin and Geneva** — Protestant reformer associated with Geneva, predestination and a strictly disciplined religious community.

**Predestination** — In Calvin's account, God's eternal decree determining each person's final end: eternal life for some and eternal damnation for others.

**Election and the elect** — God's choice of those who will receive salvation. Calvin says election rests on freely given mercy rather than human worth.

**Humility and confidence** — Election should produce humility because salvation depends on God's mercy, and confidence because those entrusted to Christ will be kept safe.

**Presbytery** — A body of ministers and devout laymen sharing authority over church government.

**Consistory** — Geneva's body of ministers and elders that enforced religious discipline. Strict conduct did not mean that people could earn election.

**Reformation Test Vocabulary and Key Terms**
**4 England**

Study guide Questions 19–23 | P&C pp. 83–85 and 92; p. 79 for East Prussia | 003H06

**Henry VIII and the royal succession** — Henry wanted a male heir to secure the Tudor dynasty. His marriage dispute led him to reject papal authority while initially retaining major Catholic doctrines.

**Annulment** — A declaration that a marriage was not valid. Henry sought an annulment of his marriage to Catherine of Aragon so he could remarry.

**Charles V** — Holy Roman Emperor and Catherine of Aragon's nephew. His power made the pope reluctant to grant Henry's request.

**Act of Supremacy and royal supremacy** — The 1534 law made the English king supreme head of the Church of England, transferring church headship from the pope to the Crown.

**Thomas More** — The humanist author of Utopia who refused to accept royal supremacy and was executed for treason. His case shows the limits placed on religious disagreement.

**Dissolution of the monasteries** — Henry closed monasteries and seized their lands. Distributing property to followers strengthened royal power and created supporters of the new settlement.

**Landed gentry** — Landowners whose new monastic property gave them a material reason to support the Tudors and the national church.

**Secularization of East Prussia** — Albert of Brandenburg turned the Teutonic Order's territory into a hereditary secular duchy in 1525. As in England, religious change transferred property and strengthened rulers.

**Edward VI** — Henry's son, whose reign from 1547 to 1553 advanced Protestant reform through adult advisers.

**Mary I** — Henry and Catherine's daughter, who restored Catholicism and papal authority from 1553 to 1558 and persecuted Protestants.

**Elizabeth I** — Henry and Anne Boleyn's daughter, who restored royal supremacy and established a Protestant national church. Her settlement required conformity rather than granting religious freedom to everyone.

**Church of England or Anglican Church** — The established national church, controlled by the monarch through Parliament. It combined Protestant teaching and English worship with bishops and much of the older hierarchy.

**Book of Common Prayer** — The English book prescribing the order of Anglican worship, introduced under Edward VI and used in the Elizabethan settlement.

**Puritans** — Protestants who wanted further changes to English church ceremonies and government.

**Recusants and conformity** — Recusants refused to attend required Church of England services. Conformity meant obeying the established church's rules; Catholics and Protestant dissenters faced restrictions.

**High Commission** — An English institution enforcing Anglican conformity under royal authority. Compare its work with Geneva's consistory and Catholic religious courts.

**Reformation Test Vocabulary and Key Terms**
**5 Catholic reform**

Study guide Questions 24–29 | P&C pp. 87–93 | 003H07

**Catholic Reformation or Counter Reformation** — Catholic renewal that addressed longstanding abuses and answered the Protestant challenge through doctrinal reaffirmation, institutional reform, education and missions.

**Council of Trent** — The Catholic council that met between 1545 and 1563. It reaffirmed Catholic doctrine while reforming clerical practice and discipline.

**Doctrine and disciplinary reform** — Doctrine concerns what the Church teaches. Disciplinary reform changes how clergy and institutions perform their duties. Trent pursued both.

**Holy See** — The pope's central authority at Rome. Trent's acts required its acceptance, preserving papal authority over the council's decisions.

**Seven sacraments** — Baptism; confirmation; Eucharist or Communion; penance or reconciliation; anointing of the sick or extreme unction; holy orders; matrimony. Trent reaffirmed all seven; Luther retained baptism and Communion.

**Eucharist and real presence** — Eucharist is another name for Communion. Both Catholic teaching and Luther affirmed Christ's real presence, although they differed over its explanation.

**Transubstantiation** — The Catholic teaching that the substance of bread and wine becomes Christ's body and blood while outward appearances remain. Luther rejected this explanation while affirming real presence.

**Trent on justification** — Trent upheld faith and good works within a life made possible by God's grace. The textbook summarizes this as faith and works combined, rather than works alone.

**Apostolic tradition** — Teachings handed down from the apostles. Trent treated Scripture and apostolic tradition as authoritative and affirmed the Church's authority to interpret them.

**Clerical celibacy and pluralism** — Celibacy required Latin Church priests to remain unmarried. Pluralism meant one person holding several church offices; Trent acted to check it.

**Diocese and seminary** — A diocese is a bishop's district. Trent required seminaries to educate and train priests, and required bishops to reside in their dioceses.

**Ignatius of Loyola and the Jesuits** — Ignatius founded the Society of Jesus, approved in 1540. Jesuits strengthened Catholicism through schools, missions and work at rulers' courts.

**Missions** — Efforts to spread a religion. Catholic missionaries sought to reconvert Protestants in Europe and convert non-Christians in Asia and the Americas.

**Orthodoxy and heresy** — Orthodoxy is teaching accepted as correct by a religious authority; heresy is teaching it condemns as contrary to the faith.

**Index of Prohibited Books** — The papal list restricting Catholic reading as a means of preventing the spread of condemned teaching.

**Roman and Spanish Inquisitions** — Institutions investigating heresy. The Roman Inquisition operated under papal authority, principally in Italy; the separate Spanish Inquisition was closely controlled by the Spanish monarchy.